robes, and even a relief of Dionysus with a drinking horn and a wine barrel. We hear about an upcoming dance performance at the pillared hall on the riverfront near the southern end of the city.

A delegation of foreigners passes by us, commenting on the wealth and worldliness of this fine city as they make their way to the superb bathing ghat, 75 m long and 15 m wide, next to a large temple at the edge of the city, near the citadel.[18] Built of brick overlaid by limestone slabs, its stepped design is adorned with aesthetically pleasing sculptural details, such as elephant balustrades. Some slabs are inscribed with board games. Nearby, stone pillars support a wooden roof, probably ‘a Goods Shed and Customs House’ for the considerable river-borne trade, since the only other route for heavy goods entering the valley is a narrow gorge in the surrounding hills, which can be used to ferry goods on bullock carts or donkeys’ backs.[19]